LINDA W. CHANG

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

The Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA
MindCORE Postdoctoral Research Fellow with Katherine L. Milkman September 2021-present

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Harvard University, Psychology 2021
Dissertation: Context-dependence in social decision-making
Advisor: Mina Cikara | Committee: Mahzarin Banaji, Max Bazerman, Sam Gershman

A.M. Harvard University, Psychology 2017

B.A. Yale University, Cognitive Science (with distinction) 2012

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

PRIMARY RESEARCH AREA

1. **Chang, L. W.**, Gershman, S. J., & Cikara, M. (2019). Comparing value coding models of context-dependence in social choice. *Journal of Experimental Social Psychology, 85,* 103847.
2. **Chang, L. W.**, & Cikara, M. (2018). Social Decoys: Leveraging choice architecture to alter social preferences. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology, 115*(2), 206-223.
3. **Chang, L. W.**, Krosch, A.R., & Cikara, M. (2016). Effects of intergroup threat on mind, brain, and behavior. *Current Opinion in Psychology, 11,* 69-73.

SECONDARY RESEARCH **(from undergraduate work on comparative cognition)**

4. Johnston, A. M., **Chang, L. W.**, Wharton, K., & Santos, L. R. (2021). Dogs (*Canis familiaris*) prioritize independent exploration over looking back. *Journal of Comparative Psychology, 135*(3), 370-381.
5. McAuliffe, K., Bogese, M., **Chang, L. W.**, Andrews, C. E., Mayer, T., Faranda, A., Hamlin, J. K., Santos, L. R. (2019). Do dogs prefer helpers in an infant-based social evaluation task? *Frontiers in Psychology, 10*, 591.
6. McAuliffe, K., **Chang, L. W.**, Leimgruber, K. L., Spaulding, R., Blake, P. R., & Santos, L. R. (2015). Capuchin monkeys (Cebus apella) show no evidence for inequity aversion in a costly choice task. *Animal Behaviour, 103*, 65-74.

WORKING PAPERS

7. **Chang, L. W.**, Chang, E. H. (under review). On the Limits of Anonymization for Promoting Diversity in Organizations.

8. **Chang, L. W.**, Cikara, M. (under review). Pre-commitment to Evaluation Criteria Improves Decision-making.

SELECTED RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

9. **Chang, L. W.**, Kirgios, E. L., Mullainathan, S., & Milkman, K. L. Quantification Myopia.
10. **Chang, L. W.**, Kirgios, E. L., Rai, A., & Milkman, K. L. Evaluating the Efficacy of the Rooney Rule in Promoting Diversity.

POPULAR PRESS

Chang, L. W. & Cikara, M. (2018, May 22). Want to Debias Hiring? Change What Hiring Managers Focus On. *Behavioral Scientist.* https://behavioralscientist.org/want-to-debias-hiring-change-what-hiring-managers-focus-on/

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

MindCORE Postdoctoral Fellowship, University of Pennsylvania 2021
Academic Grant, Sawtooth Software 2020
Summer Institute in Social and Personality Psychology (SISPP), SPSP July 2019
Certificate of Distinction in Teaching, Harvard University, Derek Bok Center for Teaching and Learning 2018
Summer Predissertation Fellowship, Harvard University, GSAS 2018
Graduate Research Fellowship, National Science Foundation 2017-2020
Diversity Fund Graduate Travel Award, Society for Personality and Social Psychology 2017
Graduate Travel Award (declined), Society for Personality and Social Psychology 2017
Elsie Hopestill Stimson Research Grant, Harvard University, Psychology Department 2015
Rev. Mary A. Vanderbilt Scholarship Fund, Harvard University, GSAS 2015-2019
Mellon Mays - Edward Bouchet Undergraduate Fellowship, Yale University 2010

INVITED RESEARCH TALKS

MindCORE Seminar Series, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA March 2022
Duckworth/Milkman Lab, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA November 2021
Emerging Scholars of Psychological Science, Princeton University, Princeton, NJ October 2019
Office of Evaluation Sciences, United States General Services Administration, Washington D.C. July 2019
Paluck Lab, Princeton University, Princeton, NJ May 2019
Cooperation Lab, Boston College, Boston, MA September 2018
Taste of Science: Dissecting the Mind, Boston, MA April 2018
Social Psychology Brown Bag, Harvard University, Cambridge, MA April 2018

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Chaired Symposia

Academy of Management (AOM), Seattle, WA 2022

- New Perspectives on Increasing Diversity and Reducing Inequality in Organizations (co-chaired with Aneesh Rai). *Selected as a showcase symposium.*

Presentations

On the Limits of Anonymization for Promoting Diversity in Organizations (Chang & Chang)

- Academy of Management (AOM), Seattle, WA. August 2022
- International Association for Conflict Management (IACM), Ottawa, Canada. July 2022

Evaluating the Efficacy of the Rooney Rule in Promoting Diversity (Chang, Kirgios, Rai, Milkman)

- Academy of Management (AOM), Seattle, WA. August 2022

Pre-commitment to evaluation criteria improves decision-making (Chang, Bazerman, Bohnet, Cikara)

- Judgment and Decision Making Preconference at SPSP, Data-blitz, Virtual February 2021
- Intervention Science Preconference at SPSP, Data-blitz, Virtual February 2021

Who counts as context? (Chang & Cikara)

- New England Research on Decision-Making (NERD), Cambridge, MA. June 2019

Social Decoys: Leveraging choice architecture to alter social preferences (Chang & Cikara)

- Association for Psychological Science Convention (APS), Washington, D.C. May 2019
- New England Research on Decision-Making (NERD), Providence, RI. May 2017

POSTER PRESENTATIONS

Pre-commitment to evaluation criteria improves decision-making (Chang, Bazerman, Bohnet, Cikara)

- Social Cognition Preconference at SPSP, Virtual February 2021

Who counts as context? (Chang & Cikara)

- Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP), New Orleans, LA. February 2020

Manipulating attribute exposure to drive social decoy effects (Chang & Cikara)

- Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP), Portland, OR. February 2019

Social decoys: Leveraging choice architecture to alter social preferences (Chang & Cikara)

- Society for Judgment and Decision Making (SJDM), New Orleans, LA. November 2018

Divisive normalization drives context dependence in social choice (Chang, Gershman, & Cikara)

- Social & Affective Neuroscience Society (SANS), Brooklyn, NY. May 2018
- Judgment and Decision-Making Preconference at SPSP, Atlanta, GA. March 2018

Engineering opportunity: Manipulating choice architecture to attenuate social bias (Chang & Cikara)

- Association for Psychological Science Convention (APS), Boston, MA. May 2017
- Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP), San Antonio, TX. January 2017
- Social Cognition Preconference at SPSP, San Antonio, TX. January 2017

Capuchin monkeys show no evidence for inequity aversion in a costly choice task (Chang, Leimbgruber, Spaulding, Blake, McAuliffe, Santos)

- Day of Cognitive Science at Yale University, New Haven, CT. April 2015
- Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD), Philadelphia, PA. March 2015

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Fellow

Methods of Behavioral Research (Instructor: Mina Cikara), Harvard University Spring 2018

Guest Lecturer

Science for Bioethicists (Instructor: Molly Lucas), Columbia University — Spring 2022
Applied Psychology Practicum (Instructor: Jenny Fauci), Boston College — Fall 2017

MENTORING AND SERVICE

Step-Ahead Mentorship Program (STAMP), MindCORE, University of Pennsylvania — 2021
Future Forward Program, Alum Presenter, Kent Place School, Middle School — 2021
Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Alum Council, Kent Place School, Summit, NJ — 2020-present
Prospective Ph.D. & RA Event in Psychology (PPREP), Harvard Psychology Department — 2020, 2021
Undergraduate Diversity Award Winners, Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP) — 2018
Leadership Alliance Program, Summer Research Opportunities at Harvard (SROH) — 2018, 2020
Harvard Science Research Conference, Harvard College Undergraduate Research Association — 2016
The ROOTS Project Inc., Bloomfield, NJ — 2013-present
Martin Luther King Jr. Youth Empowerment Conference, Ceceilyn Miller Institute — 2011-2012
Lead For Diversity, American Conference On Diversity — 2008-2011

MEMBERSHIPS AND ASSOCIATIONS

Professional Affiliations

Academy of Management (AOM), Association for Psychological Science (APS), International Association for Conflict Management (IACM), Society for Judgment and Decision Making (SJDM), Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP)

Associations

Association of Asian American Yale Alumni (AAYA), Yale GALA LGBT Alumni Association

AD HOC REVIEWING

Behavioral Science & Policy, European Journal of Social Psychology, Group Processes & Intergroup Relations, Journal of Experimental Social Psychology, Management Science, Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin, Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences

APPENDIX: ABSTRACTS FROM PUBLISHED AND WORKING PAPERS

Chang, L. W., & Cikara, M. (2018). Social Decoys: Leveraging choice architecture to alter social preferences. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology, 115*(2), 206-223.

Many of society's most significant social decisions are made over sets of individuals: for example, evaluating a collection of job candidates when making a hiring decision. Rational theories of choice dictate that decision makers' preferences between any two options should remain the same irrespective of the number or quality of other options. Yet people's preferences for each option in a choice set shift in predictable ways as function of the available alternatives. These violations are well documented in consumer behavior contexts: for example, the decoy effect, in which introducing a third inferior product changes consumers' preferences for two original products. The current experiments test the efficacy of *social decoys* and harness insights from computational models of decision-making to examine whether choice set construction can be used to change preferences in a hiring context. Across seven experiments (N = 6312) we find that participants have systematically different preferences for the exact same candidate as a function of the other candidates in the choice set (Experiments 1a–1d, 2) and the salience of the candidate attributes under consideration (Experiments 2, 3a, 3b). Specifically, compromise and (often) asymmetric-dominance decoys increased relative preference for their yoked candidates when candidates were counter-stereotypical (e.g., high warmth/low competence male candidate). More importantly, we demonstrate for the first time that we can mimic the effect of a decoy in the absence of a third candidate by manipulating participants' exposure to candidates' attributes: balanced exposure to candidates' warmth and competence information significantly reduced bias between the two candidates.

Chang, L. W., Gershman, S. J., & Cikara, M. (2019). Comparing value coding models of context-dependence in social choice. *Journal of Experimental Social Psychology, 85,* 103847.

Decision-makers consistently exhibit violations of rational choice theory when they choose among several alternatives in a set (e.g., failing to buy the best product in a set when it is presented alongside high-quality alternatives). Many of society's most significant social decisions similarly involve the joint evaluation of multiple candidates. Are social decisions subject to the same violations, and if so, what account best characterizes the nature of the violations? Across five studies, we tested whether decision-makers exhibit context-dependent preferences in hiring scenarios and past U.S. congressional race outcomes and compared different models of value coding as sources of the hypothesized context-dependence. Studies 1a, 1b, and 1d revealed that a divisive normalization value coding scheme best characterized participants' choices across a series of hiring decisions, and that participants exhibited context-dependent preferences. However, the distractor had the opposite effect of that predicted by divisive normalization once we accounted for the random effect of participant: as the value of the distractor increased, participants were

more likely to hire the highest-valued candidate. In Study 2, we used a combination of archival electoral data and survey data to examine whether normalization models could explain the outcomes of congressional elections. Electoral outcomes were predicted by political candidates' inferred competence, but this time in line with the divisive normalization account. Our findings offer mixed support for a formal, neurobiologically-derived account of when and how specific alternatives exert their effects on social evaluation and choice, and highlight conditions under which high-value distractors increase versus decrease relative choice accuracy.

Chang, L. W., Cikara, M. Pre-commitment to Evaluation Criteria Improves Decision-making.

Discrimination in employment contexts has been widely studied and documented. While various interventions have successfully decreased the impact of group-based bias in hiring, these interventions can have mixed results and may only apply to a limited set of scenarios. Across two experiments (N = 1200), we examined whether asking evaluators to pre-commit to evaluation criteria—by ranking criteria from most to least important *prior* to evaluating candidates—would decrease discrimination based on irrelevant information, such as the candidate's place of birth and body weight. When participants pre-committed to their criteria, they made *better* decisions (compared to control participants): specifically, they made more fine-grained distinctions between the different levels (e.g., very experienced vs. somewhat experienced) of the *relevant* criteria (e.g., previous experience). The results of these experiments have practical implications for how we structure decision-making processes in consequential social choices, including hiring and promotion, in pursuit of less discriminatory outcomes.

Chang, L. W., Chang, E. H. On the Limits of Anonymization for Promoting Diversity in Organizations.

One recommended strategy to increase diversity in organizations is to anonymize job applicant resumes. However, real-world, large-scale tests of anonymization have shown mixed results for increasing diversity in interview call-back rates and job offers. We consider decision-makers' social dominance orientation (SDO), a measure of anti-egalitarianism/endorsement of group-based hierarchy, to understand why anonymization has not been universally successful in the field. Across three studies (N = 2400), we show SDO moderates the effects of anonymization: anonymization decreases selection of underrepresented groups for lower SDO individuals and increases selection for higher SDO individuals. In addition, egalitarians are more likely to opt into anonymized hiring processes, but in doing so, they hire underrepresented groups at lower rates as compared to using non-anonymized hiring processes. Our findings suggest that anonymization is not a silver-bullet solution for increasing diversity, and managers should be careful when deciding whether to implement anonymization in their hiring processes.